

Soc Internship Day 18

1. Explain Malware

Malware (malicious software) is any software designed to damage, disrupt, steal data, or gain unauthorized access to a computer system.

Common types of malware:

- Virus – Attaches to files and spreads when executed.
 - Worm – Self-replicates across networks without user action.
 - Trojan – Disguises itself as legitimate software.
 - Ransomware – Encrypts files and demands payment.
 - Spyware – Secretly collects user information.
 - Adware – Displays unwanted advertisements.
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2. Identify Indicators of Malware Infection

Common Indicators of Compromise (IoCs) include:

- Slow system performance
- Unexpected pop-up ads
- Unknown programs running
- High CPU or network usage
- Antivirus being disabled
- Files suddenly encrypted or renamed
- Unauthorized user accounts created
- Suspicious outbound connections to unknown IP addresses
- Unusual login attempts or system crashes

Example:

A user opens an email attachment, and shortly afterward all files get a .locked extension with a ransom note. This is a strong indicator of a ransomware infection.

3. Describe the Response to Malware

A standard incident response process is:

1. Detect
 - Identify the malware through alerts or suspicious behavior.
2. Contain
 - Disconnect the infected device from the network to stop the spread.
3. Analyze
 - Determine the malware type, affected systems, and attack method.
4. Eradicate
 - Remove the malware using security tools or reinstall the affected system if necessary.

5. Recover

- Restore clean backups and verify the system is functioning normally.

6. Report & Improve

- Document the incident, notify stakeholders, and update security controls to prevent recurrence.